

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a local newspaper:

Boxing champion Rex Tso reveals secret of success

Rex Tso Sing-yu, a.k.a. The Wonder Kid, has fought 18 professional boxing matches since 2011 and won them all.

This year was definitely an important year for Tso. Yet despite his busy fighting schedule, he was able to help many worthwhile causes and serve as an inspiration for youngsters who feel lost and have no direction in life.

"I think sports are good for children and teenagers, especially boxing," said Tso. "Not until I started professional boxing did I find my life goals."

As a teenager, he thought of himself as "junk". He didn't do well academically or in other things, except playing video games.

After secondary school, he and his friends tried out all sorts of jobs, including being a warehouse worker and a driver. But all those jobs were short-lived as Tso felt he was physically unfit and needed to be stronger to do this type of work.

Tso's life turned a new page when Jay Lau Chi-yuen opened a boxing gym and invited him over.

That's when he really picked up boxing and began to enter professional matches.

"Boxing teaches you the need to work hard," said Tso. "When fighting, you feel under immense stress and quickly learn to control your emotions and develop self-control. Outside the ring, you have to be disciplined about food and learn to keep to your training schedule. These are important life skills."

Your group has been asked to write a letter to Rex Tso inviting him to speak at your school. You are meeting to discuss the letter. You may want to talk about:

- why Rex would be a suitable speaker
- how to persuade Rex to come to your school
- whether boxing should be promoted in secondary schools in Hong Kong
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to try boxing?
2. Is boxing a popular sport in Hong Kong?
3. Do you like watching boxing on TV?
4. Should girls do boxing?
5. Does boxing get enough support in Hong Kong?
6. Why do some people enjoy dangerous sports such as boxing?
7. Do you think boxing encourages violence?
8. Is it important to let young people take risks through activities such as boxing?